

them and using this knowledge to gain and grow a audience. An analysis of your consumers comes at the very beginning of deriving a growth hack for your business. Several successful startups directly attribute their success to a keen understanding of their consumer base. Many have pivoted or changed their strategy after an in depth analysis. Take Instagram. It originally started as Burbn, an app that allowed location-aware photo and note-sharing. After drilling down into what their audience was really interested in and what they were mainly using it for, they pared it down to the photo sharing app that everybody knows and most people love today. The questions remain- Where does this data come from? How to make sense of it?

If you do a simple Google search on the keywords 'How to earn money online' or 'How to make money from home', one of the popular suggestions you will see is to run your own blog or e-commerce website. Indeed if you have followed our previous Fast Track issues, even we've covered topics on how you can be a freelancer, run your online business etc. And it's all sound advice. You set up your website, run the marketing campaigns and are beginning to see a trickle of users flocking to your website. But how can this trickle be turned into a flood? And how many of them are actually regular followers or are converting into paid customers? Where are they coming from? Answers to all such questions lies in two words – Google Analytics.

Even if you don't have an online business, don't make the mistake of assuming that you don't require GA. You probably have a website (and if don't, hello it's 2018! Get one ASAP) and you must be running online campaigns for your offline business. E.g. if you own a florist shop, you can use your website to promote it and raise awareness of your shop. A measurable goal for your business might be visitors downloading your brochure or filling up a form or even viewing the location page. With GA, you can track the effectiveness of your strategy and tweak it accordingly.

Google Analytics is a tool that allows you to monitor and understand your online viewership. As the name suggests, it analyses your website traffic and tells you where the visitors are coming from, what their behavioural patterns are, which marketing campaigns are working most effectively etc. Just a few sample questions that can be answered using analytics are:

- How many people visit my website?
- Where do my visitors live?
- Do I need a mobile-friendly website?
- Which websites send traffic to my website?
- What marketing tactics drive the most traffic to my website?